

A 40mm L/60 Bofors anti-aircraft gun deployed at Madhopur headworks, Punjab sector. The majority of the Indian Army's anti-aircraft artillery regiments were equipped with these vintage guns during the 1965 war. By 1971 some of the regiments had been equipped with radar-controlled 40mm L/70 Bofors guns but the mainstay was still the manually operated L/60. They performed creditably during both the Indo-Pakistani wars, shooting down more than 30 Pakistani aircraft. (Author's Collection)

The eastern sector saw the war's most intense fighting, with IV Corps operating on three divisional thrust lines from Sylhet in the north to Chittagong in the south. IV Corps was to liberate all areas east of the Meghna, cut off communications to Chittagong and force a crossing over the Meghna to head for Dacca. The northern thrust, made by 8 Mountain Division, saw 81 Mountain Brigade advancing on the Kulaura–Sylhet axis and 59 Mountain Brigade moving on the Kulaura–Frenchganj–Sylhet axis; the division destroyed all opposition en route to Sylhet. On 7 December in a daring heliborne operation, 4/5 GORKHA RIFLES was landed in Sylhet to